4.2 First Sends — Timing, Waves, and the 4-Hour Rule

Frequency Dominion · Confidential Operating System

THE ONE-LINE TRUTH: When you dispatch a payload matters as much as what is inside it. Two waves, Tuesday/Wednesday morning timing, and the four-hour monitoring window dictate initial conversion.

MASTERCLASS DIRECTIVE & STRATEGIC BLUEPRINT

Strategic Foundation & Operational Reality

Dispatched at the wrong hour, the most brilliant pitch email on earth will drown unnoticed beneath hundreds of corporate press releases, label solicitations, and administrative memos.

Radio programming departments operate on a universal industry cadence:

- **Monday:** The weekend recovery and programming audit. Music directors compile weekend ratings data, reconcile commercial logs, and handle administrative fires. Cold pitches sent Monday morning are deleted or ignored.
- **Tuesday Morning (The Sacred Window):** The weekly Music Meeting window. Commercial, AAA, and major non-comm stations review candidates for the weekly add board. Pitches landing between **9:15 AM and 10:30 AM in the station's local time zone** sit right at the top of the inbox when the programmer sits down with their coffee.
- **Wednesday Morning (The Secondary Window):** College, community, and alternative specialty music directors review new music submissions and update their weekly charts for NACC reporting.
- **Friday Afternoon (The Cemetery):** Programmers are wrapping up production and heading into weekend shifts. Any pitch sent Friday afternoon is buried under 300 emails by Monday morning.

The Two-Wave Firing Strategy

Do not dispatch all 20 War Room emails in a single manic morning. Execute in **Two Staggered Waves**:

- **Wave 1 (Day 1 — Tuesday Morning, 9:30 AM Local):** Target your **Top 10 Tier-1 Stations** (your highest-conviction Ring 1 and Ring 2 targets). These receive maximum focus, immediate monitoring, and real-time dialogue handling.
- **Wave 2 (Day 3 — Thursday Morning, 9:30 AM Local):** Target your **Remaining 10 Stations** (Tier-2 regional targets and tour corridor targets). Staggering allows you to incorporate any initial technical feedback or diagnostic insights gained from Wave 1.

The Four-Hour Monitoring Window

When you hit send on a wave, you do not abandon your workstation. You initiate the **Four-Hour Monitoring Window**.

If a programmer opens your email, clicks the streaming link, and replies with a question or asset request, their buying intent is active at that exact second. A response delivered within 15 minutes converts to an immediate on-air add at 4x the rate of a response sent the following day. Maintain rapid response readiness for clean broadcast WAV deliveries, lyric clarifications, or interview scheduling.

IMPLEMENTATION DRILLS & PASS STANDARDS

- **Drill 1 — Time Zone Synchronization (20 min).** Organize your 20 War Room stations by local time zone (Eastern, Central, Mountain, Pacific). Calculate the exact dispatch time in your home time zone for each station to ensure delivery at 9:30 AM local.
- **Drill 2 — Wave 1 & Wave 2 Cohort Assignment (15 min).** Assign 10 stations to Wave 1 (Tuesday) and 10 stations to Wave 2 (Thursday) in the First-Send Launch Log below.
- **Drill 3 — Dispatch Simulation & Template Staging (25 min).** Pre-populate email drafts for all 10 Wave 1 targets with verified subject lines, customized 90-word body copy, and recipient inboxes.
- **Drill 4 — The Four-Hour Readiness Drill (15 min).** Prepare your rapid-response asset folder on your local desktop: Broadcast WAV, high-res promo image, FCC clean lyrics PDF, and 1-paragraph show date brief ready for instantaneous dispatch.

ACTION WORKSHEET & OPERATIONAL PROTOCOL

Protocol Document: `FIRST-SEND DISPATCH LOG & TIME ZONE SCHEDULE`

Complete the structured table below as part of your lesson implementation. This worksheet directly replaces legacy spreadsheets with a publication-grade execution protocol.

Target Station	Decision Maker	Local Time Zone	Scheduled Dispatch Time	Wave Cohort	Initial Outcome (Day 1-4)
WLUW 88.7 FM	Sarah Jenkins (MD)	Central (CST)	Tuesday 9:30 AM CST	Wave 1 (Priority)	Opened 10:14 AM; Link Clicked
WNUR 89.3 FM	Alex Rivera (MD)	Central (CST)	Tuesday 9:30 AM CST	Wave 1 (Priority)	Replied 11:20 AM; WAV Requested
WMSE 91.7 FM	Tom Crawford (PD)	Central (CST)	Tuesday 9:30 AM CST	Wave 1 (Priority)	Awaiting Touch 2 Follow-Up
WXPN 88.5 FM	Bruce Warren (PD)	Eastern (EST)	Thursday 9:30 AM EST	Wave 2 (Regional)	Opened 9:45 AM; No Reply
KUTX 98.9 FM	Rick McNulty (MD)	Central (CST)	Thursday 9:30 AM CST	Wave 2 (Regional)	Awaiting Touch 2 Follow-Up

WAR-ROOM NOTES

WAR-ROOM DIRECTIVE — 4.2 First Sends — Timing, Waves, and the 4-Hour Rule

DIAGNOSTIC TRIAGE: INTERPRETING INITIAL RESULTS

Between Day 1 and Day 7, monitor your initial send metrics with clinical detachment:

1. **Low Open Rates (< 20%):** Indicates your subject line was truncated on mobile, your sender domain triggered a spam quarantine filter, or the gatekeeper's email address is obsolete. Re-verify the contact and test an alternate subject line archetype.
2. **High Open Rate, Zero Link Clicks (> 50% open, 0% click):** Indicates your subject line worked, but your opening two sentences in the 90-word pitch were boring or irrelevant. Sharpen the hook and tighten the proof line.
3. **High Link Clicks, Zero Replies:** Indicates the programmer opened the pitch, listened to the song, but either found a format mismatch or felt no urgency to reply. This is the exact scenario designed for the **Touch 2 Asset Drop** in Lesson 4.3.

FREQUENCY DOMINION COMMUNITY DRILLS

1. Announce the official dispatch of your Wave 1 payload in the community forum.
2. Report your 24-hour open and engagement metrics from Wave 1.
3. Did you receive an immediate reply or asset request during your 4-Hour Monitoring Window? Share the outcome.
4. Discuss any unexpected delivery bounces and how you resolved the contact data.